

STANDARD CHARTERED (2888.HK/STAN.L)

## ROTE upside still underappreciated after the rally; upgrade to Buy

We upgrade STAN (2888.HK and STAN.L) to Buy from Neutral, and revise our 12-month target prices to HK\$203 (from HK\$168) and 1,965p (from 1,670p). Despite the +83%/+72% share price rally for 2888.HK/STAN.L year-to-date (vs. +27%/20% for HSI/FTSE World Europe), we see room for further re-rating, with their current valuation of 1.2X P/TB (2888.HK) providing **compelling valuation upside** compared to its DM peers with similar profitability profiles. This is especially driven by our increased conviction in the bank's **sustained improving profitability outlook**, where we forecast underlying ROTES to reach 14.6% by the end of 2025E (exceeding management's guidance of 13% ROTE) and to rise further to 15.0% by 2027E and 15.7% by 2028E. As such, we anticipate STAN will upgrade its ROTE guidance for the medium term at its FY2025 results or its upcoming Investor Day in May 2026, which should serve as a further catalyst for the shares. We expect STAN to consistently deliver solid quarterly earnings that will help enhance investor confidence, which should lead to a re-rating of the shares back to its 2011-2014 median valuation of 1.4X P/B, when it had a similar profitability profile. Additionally, when we value its wealth business on a standalone basis, we note its stub valuation appears attractive at 5.0X 2025E P/E.

The bank is demonstrating strong execution across revenue and cost lines to deliver improving profitability. This positive trajectory is underpinned by three key factors, where we see sustained momentum driven by structural tailwinds and/or low-hanging fruit: **(1) Robust and sustained momentum in the affluent segment**, which accounts for 28% of revenue. Given its regional network strength, differentiated product offerings, and strategic focus on wealth, we see the bank as well-positioned to leverage the robust and sustained liquidity inflows into Hong Kong and Singapore, a significant tailwind that we believe will continue to fuel its growth and differentiate its performance from peers. STAN has delivered above-peers AUM growth and net new money inflows in 2024-1H25. Coupled with decent fee-charging capabilities, supported by diversified product offerings and scaling advisory capabilities that demonstrate an improved wealth franchise, we see STAN on track to deliver on its target of double-digit income CAGR in wealth solutions income for 2025-2029, to help support group top-line. **(2) Positive trajectory in Global Markets and Banking**, underpinned by steady market share gains given its large network and the structural rise in cross-border flows. **(3) Positive jaws with scope to further unlock operational leverage.** STAN's disciplined cost management and

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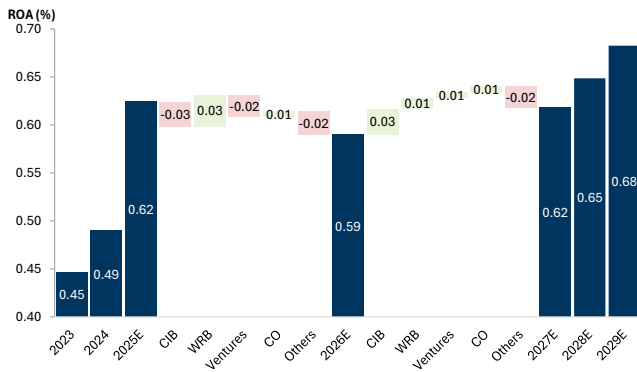
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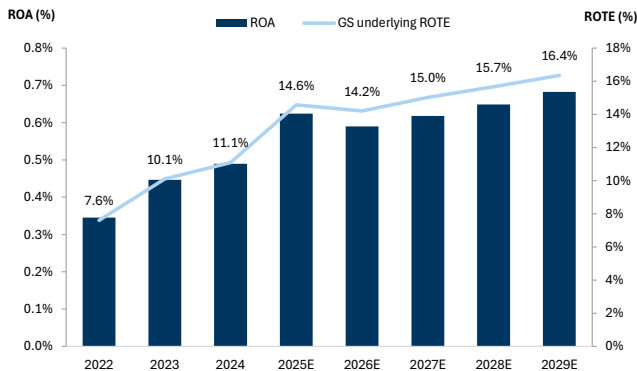
improving operational efficiency alongside robust revenue growth are driving delivery of positive jaws. We see additional room for operational leverage through deeper streamlining of its staff-heavy and support services-intensive cost base through further advances in technology (which it has started to adopt), which should create a clear path for sustaining and enhancing positive jaws over the medium term.

Additionally, **STAN offers attractive shareholder returns** with an 8.4% total yield (dividend + buybacks) for 2026E, ranking among the top quartile of DM comps. Our analysis suggests that given STAN's robust capital generation capabilities should enable a sustained total payout ratio at 80% in the long term. Thus, we raise our 2028-2029E share buyback forecasts to \$2.8bn per year (from \$2.5bn), and also raise our 2026-2028E DPO to 25%/30%/35% from a flat 21% previously. The revised forecasts imply an average total payout ratio of 75% for 2026E-2028E. We expect this proactive capital management to further support ROTE and valuation re-rating.

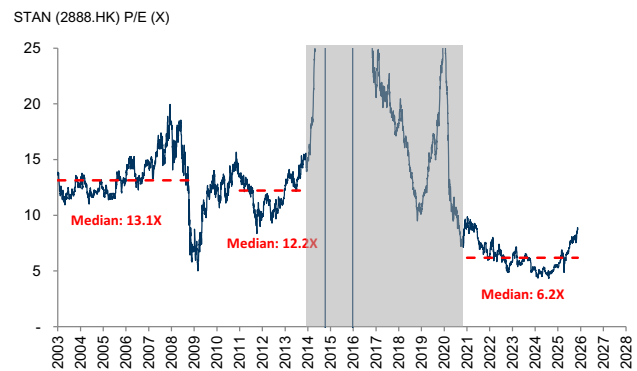
*With this report, Melissa Kuang has assumed primary coverage responsibility for STAN (2888.HK). Chris Hallam continues to have primary coverage responsibility for STAN (STAN.L).*

**Exhibit 1: We expect STAN to maintain ROA in 2026-2027E...**


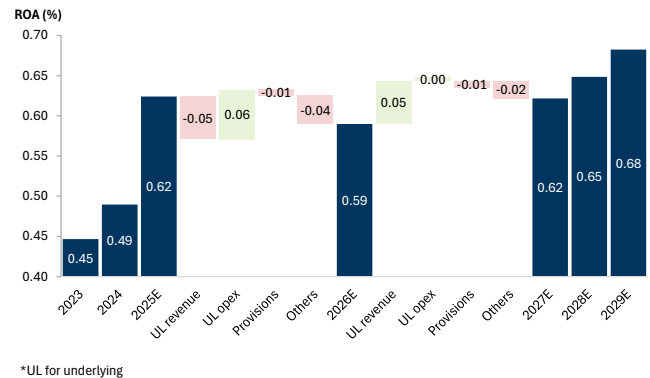
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 3: ...and ROTE to remain above 14% in 2026E and improve further thereafter**


Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

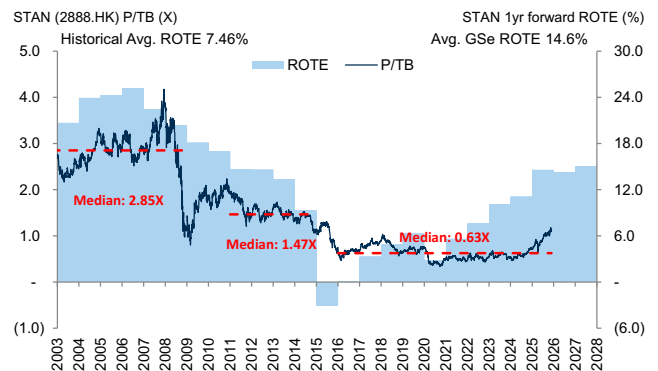
**Exhibit 5: ...and it is trading at 9.0X P/E, more than 1 standard deviation above its 5-year median**


Source: Thomson Reuters Eikon, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

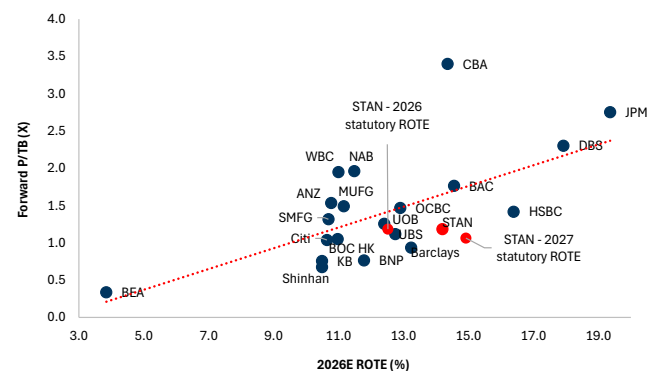
**Exhibit 2: ...with support across operating lines...**


\*UL for underlying

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 4: STAN (2888.HK) is currently trading at 1.2X P/TB, more than 1 standard deviation above its 10-year median, supported by an improving ROTE outlook...**


Source: Thomson Reuters Eikon, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 6: We see valuation as still attractive compared to peers**


STAN P/TB is for (2888.HK) and HSBC P/TB is (0005.HK)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

## #1. Affluent Wealth business a sustained growth driver

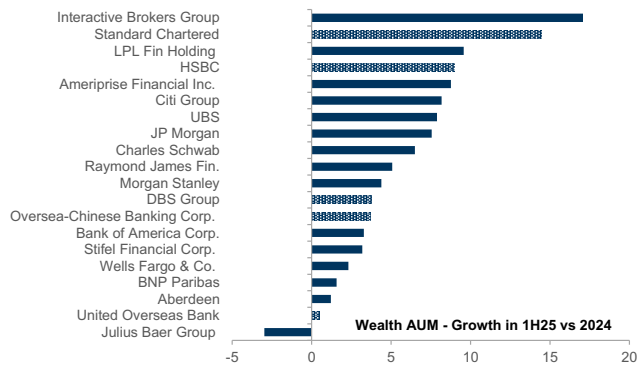
Affluent income now accounts for 28% of group revenue and has delivered a robust 18% growth CAGR during 2022-9M25, outpacing the 8% CAGR of the group, underscoring this segment's importance to group growth. STAN has considerably strengthened its proposition in this segment in the past two years, narrowing the gap with HSBC and DBS — the region's dominant wealth franchises — through: (1) A broadened product shelf; (2) Increased focus on high-margin sophisticated products; (3) Presence across all key high-growth wealth hubs; and (4) An enhanced offering for the mass-affluent segment. Execution has resulted in strong momentum, with AUM rising to \$438bn by 9M25, with growth ahead of peers, driven by sustained robust net new money (NNM) inflows of \$42bn YTD (+24% yoy), which represents 15% of AUM growth (annualized). This is also reflected in its gains in market share of deposits in HK and SG where these deposits can subsequently be converted into AUM. Management is targeting to attract an average of \$40bn in NNM per year in 2025-2029, vs. the \$27bn average in 2021-2024, reflecting its confidence in sustained client acquisition. Furthermore, the effective fee rate of STAN's affluent business is higher than peers', supported by its diversified product offering and scaling advisory capabilities. With a clear strategic focus and operational momentum, the group targets achieving a double-digit CAGR in wealth solutions income growth in 2025-2029.

We see upside to the group's guidance on the back of robust liquidity flows into HK and SG as the financial hubs in Asia. We note that the structural sustainability of Asia wealth growth is underpinned by: (1) A structurally stronger macro backdrop in Asia, with the region delivering higher GDP than the global average, (2) A rapidly expanding middle class, (3) A young, growing, and urbanizing population, (4) A high savings and investment culture, and (5) Ongoing financialisation of savings across cash-rich Asian economies. One region in which we see as a major driver for wealth inflows into HK and SG is China where we estimate a TAM of US\$7-10trn to be invested in financial assets over time for both regional and global players. We see STAN well-placed to benefit from this inflow given its regional presence and improved product suite (see [Riding Asia's liquidity wave: the earnings engine of HK/SG Banks](#)). We forecast 15% wealth fee income growth CAGR for 2024-2027E, supporting our group operating income growth forecast of 5% CAGR during the same period.

Wealth is a highly profitable business and we estimate wealth ROTE of 52% ([Exhibit 14](#)) for STAN, higher than its group ROTE at 11% in 2024 and 14.6% in 2025E. Hence, stronger growth in wealth should uplift overall group ROTEs. Our analysis shows that every 5% growth in invested AUM, at current fees on invested AUM of 1.3%, will uplift earnings by 1.4% and ROTE by 20bps.

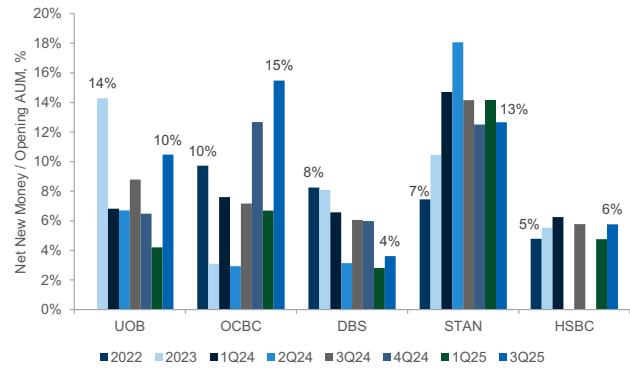
To better understand how the market values STAN's wealth business, we use the peer average valuation of the major wealth players, such as UBS, Julius Baer, Citi, JPM, and MS, to value STAN's wealth business. Applying peer comps for the income generated by the wealth business for 2025, we arrive at a valuation of \$33.5bn for the affluent business. This implies the remaining group (ex-affluent business) would trade at a FY25E P/E of only 5.0X, which is below its DM peers at 13.4X 2025E P/E. In our view, this suggests that the market has yet to fully appreciate STAN's wealth business, its growth and profitability, and/or the profitability and growth potential of the rest of the group.

### Exhibit 7: STAN leads growth in Wealth Management vs global peers... YTD growth



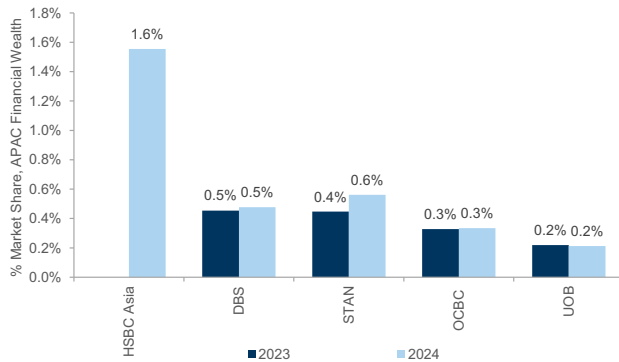
Source: Company data

### Exhibit 8: ... with net new money as a % of opening AUM continuing to remain strong...



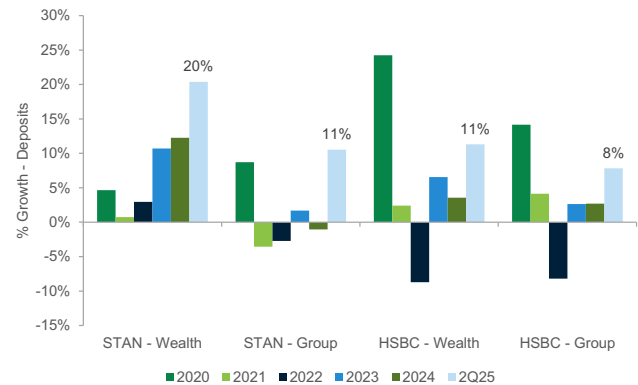
Source: Company data

### Exhibit 9: ... resulting in market share gains of 20bps in APAC Financial Wealth



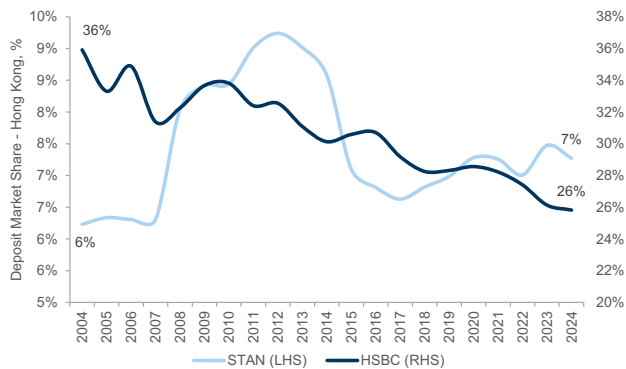
Source: BCG Global Wealth Report 2025, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

### Exhibit 10: STAN has garnered strong retail inflows, with growth in wealth deposits surpassing overall growth



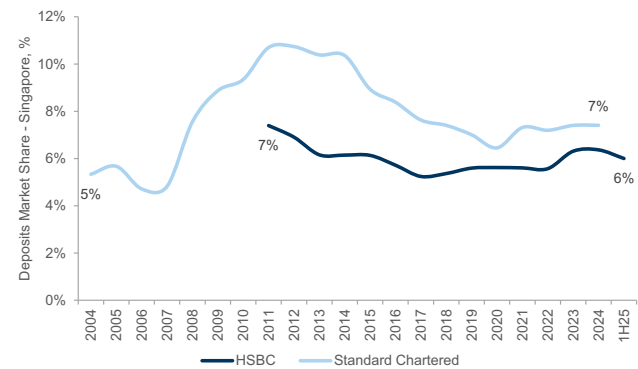
Source: Company data

### Exhibit 11: On deposits, STAN gained market share in Hong Kong...



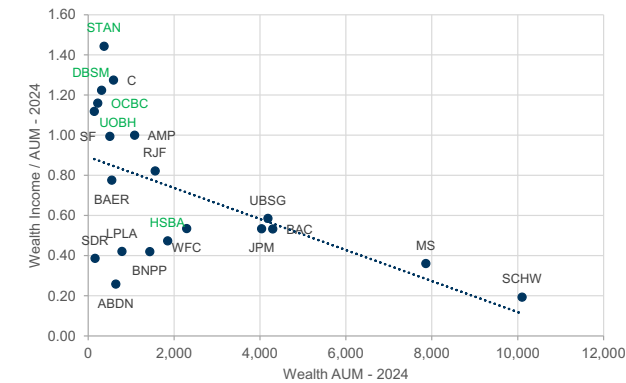
Source: Company data

### Exhibit 12: ...and in Singapore



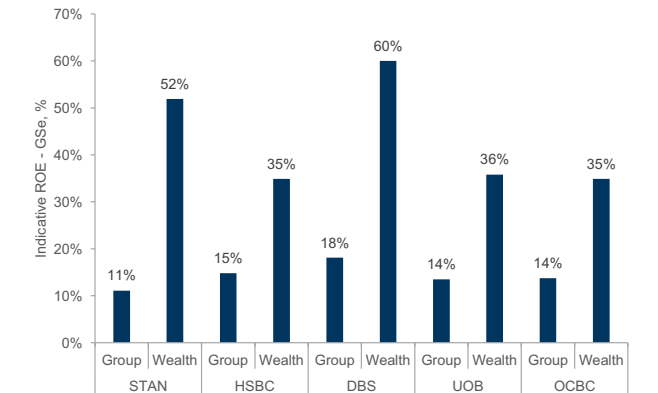
Source: Company data

Exhibit 13: STAN’s wealth margins are the highest amongst peers



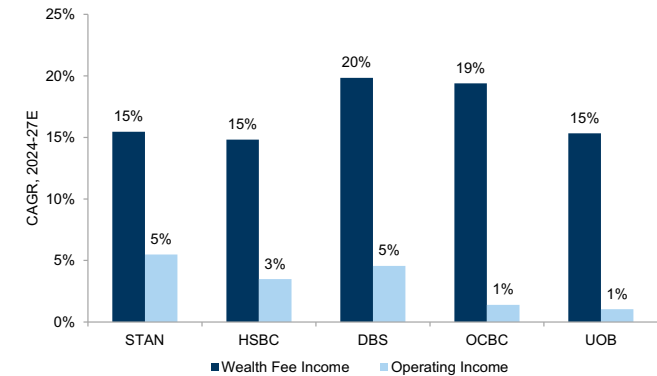
Source: Company data

Exhibit 14: Moreover, our analysis suggests that STAN earns ROTE of 52% on the Wealth business, vs the group at 11%, offering significant tailwinds to earnings



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 15: We expect wealth fee income to grow stronger to support group operating income



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 16: Earnings and ROE accretion potential from AUM growth

| STAN                                            |      |      |      |      |      |       |       |                                     |                    |      |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |
|-------------------------------------------------|------|------|------|------|------|-------|-------|-------------------------------------|--------------------|------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| Operating Income uplift if deposits came as AUM |      |      |      |      |      |       |       | ROTE uplift if deposits came as AUM |                    |      |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |
| Growth                                          |      |      |      |      |      |       |       | Growth                              |                    |      |       |       |       |       |       |       |       |
| Invested AUM                                    |      | 3.0% | 5.0% | 7.0% | 9.0% | 11.0% | 13.0% | 15.0%                               | Invested AUM       |      | 3.0%  | 5.0%  | 7.0%  | 9.0%  | 11.0% | 13.0% | 15.0% |
| Wealth deposit                                  |      | 1.1% | 1.9% | 2.6% | 3.3% | 4.1%  | 4.8%  | 5.6%                                | Wealth deposit     |      | 1.1%  | 1.9%  | 2.6%  | 3.3%  | 4.1%  | 4.8%  | 5.6%  |
| Fees on Invested AUM                            | 1.0% | 0.8% | 1.3% | 1.8% | 2.3% | 2.8%  | 3.3%  | 3.8%                                | AUM Fees on Assets | 1.1% | 9bps  | 15bps | 20bps | 26bps | 32bps | 38bps | 43bps |
|                                                 | 1.1% | 0.8% | 1.3% | 1.8% | 2.4% | 2.9%  | 3.4%  | 3.9%                                |                    | 1.2% | 10bps | 16bps | 23bps | 29bps | 36bps | 42bps | 49bps |
|                                                 | 1.2% | 0.8% | 1.4% | 1.9% | 2.5% | 3.0%  | 3.5%  | 4.1%                                |                    | 1.3% | 11bps | 18bps | 25bps | 33bps | 40bps | 47bps | 54bps |
|                                                 | 1.3% | 0.8% | 1.4% | 2.0% | 2.5% | 3.1%  | 3.7%  | 4.2%                                |                    | 1.4% | 12bps | 20bps | 28bps | 36bps | 44bps | 51bps | 59bps |
|                                                 | 1.4% | 0.9% | 1.5% | 2.1% | 2.6% | 3.2%  | 3.8%  | 4.4%                                |                    | 1.5% | 13bps | 22bps | 30bps | 39bps | 47bps | 56bps | 64bps |
|                                                 | 1.5% | 0.9% | 1.5% | 2.1% | 2.7% | 3.3%  | 4.0%  | 4.6%                                |                    | 1.6% | 14bps | 23bps | 33bps | 42bps | 51bps | 61bps | 70bps |
|                                                 | 1.6% | 0.9% | 1.6% | 2.2% | 2.8% | 3.5%  | 4.1%  | 4.7%                                |                    | 1.7% | 15bps | 25bps | 35bps | 45bps | 55bps | 65bps | 75bps |

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 17: STAN has broadened its wealth offerings across the wealth continuum through new product launches, focus on high-margin cross-border clients, and presence in high-growth wealth hubs

| Product / Service Bucket                                       | Standard Chartered (SC)                                                                                                           | HSBC                                                                                                                           | UBS                                                                                                                 | DBS                                                                                                                    | BOC Hong Kong (BOCHK)                                                                                                        | UOB                                                                                                     | OCBC                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Customer Cohort                                                | <b>Premium:</b> AUM US\$25K<br><b>Priority:</b> AUM US\$100K<br><b>Private:</b> AUM US\$1mm<br><b>Private:</b> Net Worth US\$10mm | <b>Advance:</b> US\$27K<br><b>Premier:</b> US\$133K<br><b>Premier Elite:</b> US\$1mm<br><b>Private Bank:</b> Net Worth US\$2mm | <b>WM US Households:</b> US\$250K<br><b>WM International Households:</b> US\$2mm<br><b>Private Banking:</b> US\$2mm | <b>DBS Treasures:</b> US\$270K<br><b>DBS Treasures Private Client:</b> US\$1.2mm<br><b>DBS Private Bank:</b> US\$4.6mm | <b>Free Banking:</b> US\$1K<br><b>Elite Banking:</b> US\$27K<br><b>Wealth Management:</b> US\$133K<br><b>Wealth:</b> US\$1mm | <b>Wealth Banking:</b> US\$77K<br><b>Private Banking:</b> US\$270K<br><b>Private Banking:</b> US\$1.1mm | <b>Premier Banking:</b> US\$250K<br><b>Premier Private:</b> US\$1.1mm<br><b>Private Banking (Bank of Singapore):</b> US\$5mm        |
| Mix of Customer Cohort                                         | UHNW: 0.3%;<br>Mass Affluent: 52%;<br>Mass Retail: 49%                                                                            | UHNW: 0.1%;<br>Mass Affluent: 10%;<br>Mass Retail: 89%                                                                         | 54% UHNW salience in Invested Assets                                                                                | Not Disclosed                                                                                                          | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                | Not Disclosed                                                                                           | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                       |
| # of Customers                                                 | 2.5mm                                                                                                                             | c.39mm                                                                                                                         | Not Disclosed                                                                                                       | c.18.4mm (Incl. Consumer banking)                                                                                      | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                | c.8.4mm (Incl. Retail Banking)                                                                          | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                       |
| Access to Investment Products                                  | ✓                                                                                                                                 | ✓                                                                                                                              | ✓                                                                                                                   | ✓                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                       | ✓                                                                                                                                   |
| In-house Asset Management                                      | ■                                                                                                                                 | ✓                                                                                                                              | ✓                                                                                                                   | ■                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                       | ✓                                                                                                                                   |
| Years since inception                                          | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                     | 52                                                                                                                             | 27                                                                                                                  | Not Disclosed                                                                                                          | 15                                                                                                                           | 39                                                                                                      | 20                                                                                                                                  |
| AUM, as of "Period"                                            | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                     | \$73bn, as of '24                                                                                                              | \$1.773bn, as of '24 (incl. \$224bn in Asia Pacific)                                                                | Not Disclosed                                                                                                          | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                | \$28bn as of 1Q25                                                                                       | \$61bn as of 3Q25                                                                                                                   |
| Asia Pacific Coverage                                          | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                     | Australia, Hong Kong, India, Japan, Singapore, Taiwan                                                                          | Australia, Hong Kong, Singapore                                                                                     | Not Disclosed                                                                                                          | Hong Kong                                                                                                                    | Singapore, Malaysia, Indonesia, Taiwan, Thailand, Vietnam                                               | ASEAN, Greater China                                                                                                                |
| Alternatives (Third party distribution / In-house funds)       | ✓                                                                                                                                 | ✓                                                                                                                              | ✓                                                                                                                   | ✓                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                       | ✓                                                                                                                                   |
| Offering                                                       | Open architecture platform; Exclusive access to SC Ventures                                                                       | HSBC Alternatives (135 investment professionals)                                                                               | Open Architecture; Alternatives Investments within UBS AM                                                           | Open architecture platform                                                                                             | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                | Open architecture platform                                                                              | >80% YoY growth in alternative investment inflows at Bank of Singapore in 2024; FIM Alternatives Select Platform; Open architecture |
| AUM, as of "Period"                                            | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                     | USD 77bn of Alternative Assets, as of Jun-25                                                                                   | USD 450bn in Alternatives                                                                                           | Not Disclosed                                                                                                          | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                | Not Disclosed                                                                                           | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                       |
| Years since inception                                          | SC Ventures set up in 2018                                                                                                        | 35-year track record                                                                                                           | 85 Years of experience in alternative investing                                                                     | Not Disclosed                                                                                                          | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                | Not Disclosed                                                                                           | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                       |
| Discretionary Portfolio Management / Managed Portfolios (DPM)  | ✓                                                                                                                                 | ✓                                                                                                                              | ✓                                                                                                                   | ✓                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                       | ✓                                                                                                                                   |
| Offering                                                       | Open Architecture platform; Signature CIO Funds                                                                                   | Access to both third-party and HSBC AM Funds                                                                                   | Access to both third-party and In-house funds                                                                       | Open architecture platform                                                                                             | Access to both third-party and In-house funds                                                                                | Access to both third-party and In-house funds                                                           | Access to both third-party and In-house funds primarily through Bank of Singapore; OCBC's private banking arm                       |
| AUM, as of "Period"                                            | Signature CIO Funds: ~USD1mm, as of May-24                                                                                        | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                  | DPM: USD 83bn in Asia                                                                                               | DPM: USD 6bn in Asia                                                                                                   | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                | Not Disclosed                                                                                           | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                       |
| Years since inception                                          | Signature CIO Funds: Launched in 2022 with Amundi                                                                                 | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                  | Not Disclosed                                                                                                       | Not Disclosed                                                                                                          | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                | Not Disclosed                                                                                           | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                       |
| Lending & Credit Facilities to Wealth Customers                | ✓                                                                                                                                 | ✓                                                                                                                              | ✓                                                                                                                   | ✓                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                       | ✓                                                                                                                                   |
| Loan Book Outstanding under Wealth Business, as of "Period"    | Secured Wealth Products: \$22bn, as of '24                                                                                        | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                  | Gross Loans: US\$301mm, as of '24                                                                                   | Earning Assets: US\$350mm as of '24                                                                                    | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                | Not Disclosed                                                                                           | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                       |
| Insurance (Third party distribution / In-house manufacturing)  | ✓                                                                                                                                 | ✓                                                                                                                              | ✓                                                                                                                   | ✓                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                       | ✓                                                                                                                                   |
| Offering                                                       | Partnership with insurance providers                                                                                              | In-house Insurance Manufacturing                                                                                               | Partnership with insurance providers                                                                                | Partnership with insurance providers                                                                                   | In-house Insurance Manufacturing                                                                                             | Partnership with insurance providers                                                                    | In-house Insurance Manufacturing                                                                                                    |
| Market Share in Hong Kong / Singapore (QY Change / 10Y Change) | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                     | 14% in HK (+120bps / -440bps)<br>4% in SG (+198bps / +138bps)                                                                  | Not Disclosed                                                                                                       | Not Disclosed                                                                                                          | 8% in HK (+190bps / +150bps)                                                                                                 | Not Disclosed                                                                                           | 22% in SG (+328bps / +913bps)                                                                                                       |
| Cross Border services                                          | ✓                                                                                                                                 | ✓                                                                                                                              | ✓                                                                                                                   | ✓                                                                                                                      | ✓                                                                                                                            | ✓                                                                                                       | ✓                                                                                                                                   |
| # of Booking Centres                                           | 6 (Singapore, Hong Kong, India, UAE, UK, Cayman Islands)                                                                          | 19 (Across key locations in APAC, EMEA, Americas)                                                                              | Multiple booking centres across globe                                                                               | 2 (Singapore and Hong Kong)                                                                                            | 1 (Hong Kong for BOC HK entity)                                                                                              | 2 (Singapore and Hong Kong)                                                                             | 2 (Singapore and Hong Kong)                                                                                                         |
| Ranking                                                        | Private Banking: #4<br>Wealth Continuum: #2 (+1 YoY)                                                                              | Private Banking: #2<br>Wealth Continuum: #1                                                                                    | Private Banking: #1                                                                                                 | Private Banking: #3<br>Wealth Continuum: #3 (-1 YoY)                                                                   | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                | Not Disclosed                                                                                           | Not Disclosed                                                                                                                       |

Ranking from Asian Private Banker as of 2024.

Source: Company data, Asian Private Banker

Exhibit 18: We believe STAN's valuation is attractive when comparing with peers

| US\$ / \$ mn             | 2025E Wealth PAT | Average FY25E of peers (X) | Affluent business value | Current Market Cap | Current Affluent business % market Cap | Rest of group FY25E PAT | Rest of group implied FY25E P/E (X) |
|--------------------------|------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| STAN                     | 2,200            | 15.2                       | 33,495                  | 50,000             | 67%                                    | 3,304                   | 5.0                                 |
| HSBC                     | 5,038            | 15.2                       | 76,707                  | 255,600            | 30%                                    | 20,359                  | 8.8                                 |
| DBS                      | 2,503            | 15.2                       | 38,104                  | 153,771            | 25%                                    | 8,636                   | 13.4                                |
| UOB                      | 955              | 15.2                       | 14,543                  | 57,577             | 25%                                    | 3,659                   | 11.8                                |
| OCBC                     | 1,075            | 15.2                       | 16,370                  | 85,426             | 19%                                    | 6,293                   | 11.0                                |
| Average of DM peer banks |                  |                            |                         |                    |                                        |                         | 13.4                                |

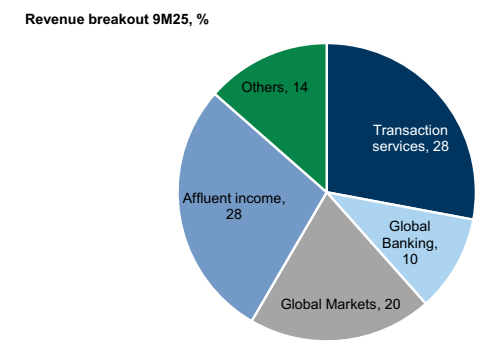
DM peers include JPM, Citi, BAC, UBS, BNP, Barclays, CBA, WBC, NAB, ANZ, MUFG, SMFG, KB, BOC HK, and BEA

Source: Company data, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

#2. Strong momentum in Global Markets and Banking

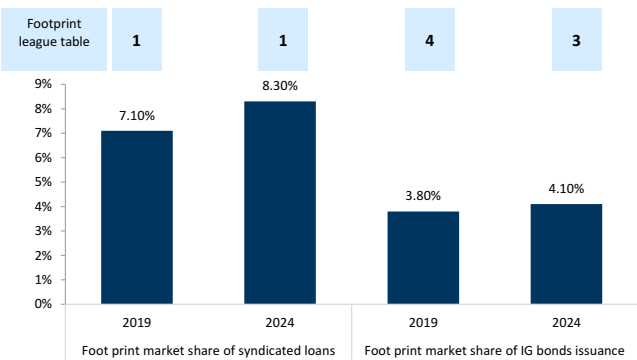
Global Banking & Markets is another key revenue driver for STAN, accounting for ~30% of the top line. It has gained momentum in recent years, delivering stronger growth than the rest of the group. In Global Markets, the franchise has strengthened with steady market share gains in the FICC revenue pools over the past few years (Exhibit 22), bolstered by innovative and bespoke solution offerings, its large network and the structural rise in cross-border flows. In Global Banking, the bank also made notable progress, gaining 1.2ppts in market share in syndicated loans to reach 8.4% by 2024, aligning with top league table positions. The bank also made comparable progress in IG bond issuance (Exhibit 21). STAN has been focusing on growing client wallet share and increasing penetration with financial institutions, and targets to deliver 5%-7% CAGR for CIB revenue in the medium term. This global markets and banking income, being largely fee/non-funds based, is not as capital-consumptive and hence supports ROTE more, as it is less constrained by capital ratios.

Exhibit 19: STAN gets ~30% of its top line from Global Markets & Banking



Source: Company data

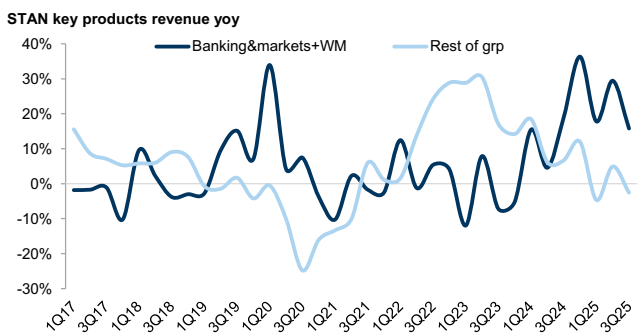
Exhibit 21: STAN gained market share in banking business and retained footprint market share leadership



Footprint refers to Asia (ex-Japan), the Middle East, and Africa (excluding CNY, NTD, ZAR)

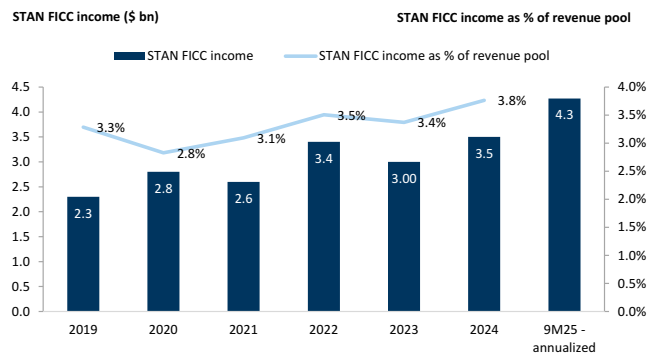
Source: Company data, Dealogic

Exhibit 20: Global Banking & Markets + Wealth have been the key revenue drivers for the group



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 22: STAN also grew FI franchise and gained market share in trading business



Footprint refers to Asia (ex-Japan), the Middle East, and Africa (excluding CNY, NTD, ZAR)

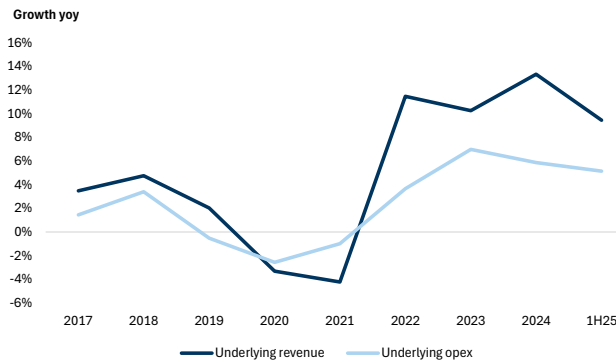
Source: Company data, Dealogic

### #3. On track to deliver positive jaws with scope to further unlock operational leverage

We see STAN on track to deliver continued improvement in Cost-to-Income Ratio (CIR), with 2ppts yoy improvement in 2026E to 57%, and a further 1ppt improvement to 56% in 2027E, supported by disciplined expense management and robust revenue momentum. So far, while STAN has made progress over the years, its CIR is still higher than peers'. That said, we see STAN delivering continued positive jaws over the next two years at a consistent rate vs. peers, which will be a lever for the bottom line as it continues to make tangible progress on operating cost efficiency through its Fit For Growth (FFG) programs, focusing on simplifying processes, driving automation, and optimizing resource allocation over 200 transformation projects. The program was targeting a total of \$1.5bn in cost savings in 2024-2026, supported by a broadly matching budgeted "cost-to-achieve (CTA)" of \$1.5bn. STAN delivered \$0.6bn in savings in 9M25, and is on track to deliver the targeted 40% run-rate savings for 2025 and 85% for 2026, with CTA largely in line with the phasing. The bank targets to spend the remainder of the CTA in 2026 and avoid spillover into 2027, which should help NPAT and thus deliver a stronger CET1 build from 2027. On opex, STAN targets to deliver positive income-to-cost jaws through 2026 (excluding notable items), and maintain 2026E opex below \$12.3bn.

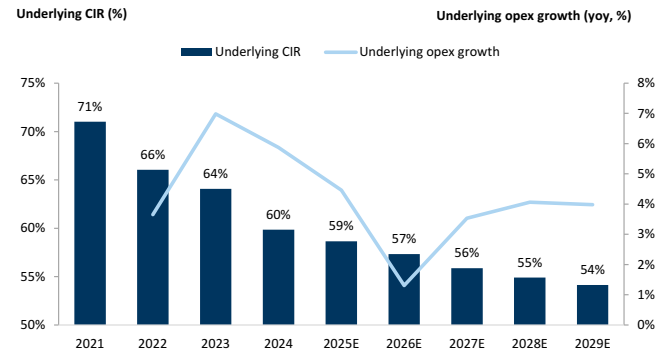
With management's focus and success in positive jaws delivery and its current program ending in 2026, we see scope for more cost-savings programs to be announced at its next Investor Day in May 2026 as we see that STAN has further potential to narrow its CIR gap to peers as noted above, as its CIR of 55% by 1H25 remains above the peer average of 43%. Employee-related cost savings are where we see scope for further opex reduction. Comparing STAN's opex breakdown, it has the highest staff cost-to-asset ratio with its other cost-to-asset ratios in line with peers. Its employee-to-asset ratio is the lowest among peers, in our view signaling lower operational efficiency per unit of balance sheet. Over the years, STAN's workforce has become increasingly concentrated in support services and contract staff rather than client-facing roles with total headcount remaining at elevated levels. Despite the proportional shifts away from business roles, staff cost per employee continues to rise and is the highest among peers. That said, we see scope for improvement through mature automation, workflow digitization, and AI-driven process optimization, etc., allowing for significant reduction in back-office dependency. STAN noted that it is adopting new technology within its FFG program, and we believe a faster rollout and deeper adoption of new technology throughout the organization should allow for structural resizing and right-sizing of its support services footprint. We expect these savings to directly contribute to positive jaws, reinforcing the already improving efficiency trend. We believe the potential for operating leverage exists for STAN to further accelerate positive jaws, expand ROTE, and unlock additional shareholder value. Our sensitivity analysis shows that a 1 ppt improvement in 2026 CIR would deliver a 2.9% uplift to earnings and a 0.4ppt uplift to ROTE.

### Exhibit 23: Disciplined cost control with strong revenue growth since 2022....



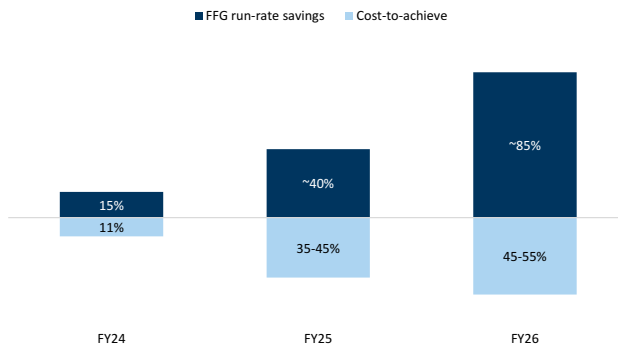
Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

### Exhibit 24: ... drove positive jaws, and we expect single-digit opex growth and positive income-to-cost jaws going forward



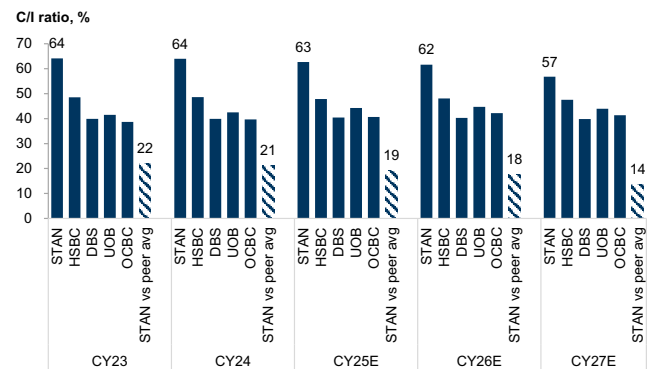
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

### Exhibit 25: STAN targets to achieve 85% of run-rate savings from the FFG program by FY26



Source: Company data

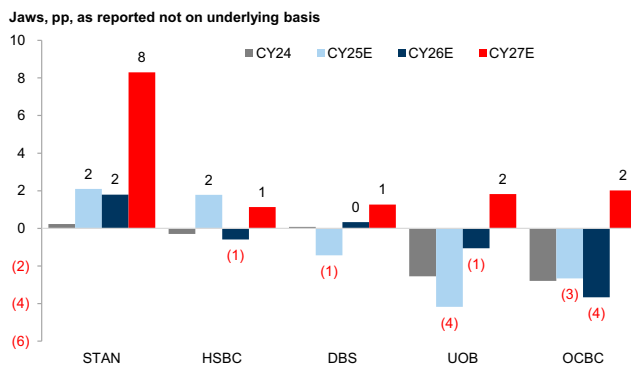
### Exhibit 26: Despite recent improvements, STAN still has a gap vs. peers in CIR, indicating room for further improvement



STAN CIR is on reported basis

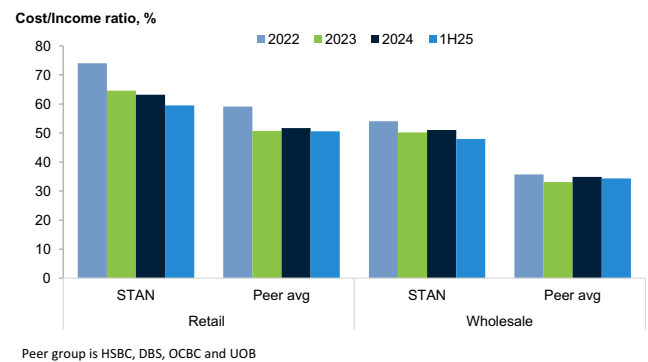
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

### Exhibit 27: We expect STAN to over-deliver on jaws in 2026E and 2027E



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

### Exhibit 28: STAN has higher CIR in both retail and wholesale than its peers

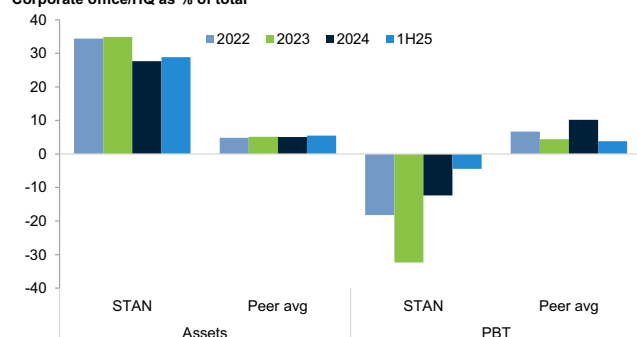


Peer group is HSBC, DBS, OCBC and UOB

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 29: STAN has a higher CO burden vs. peers**

Corporate office/HQ as % of total

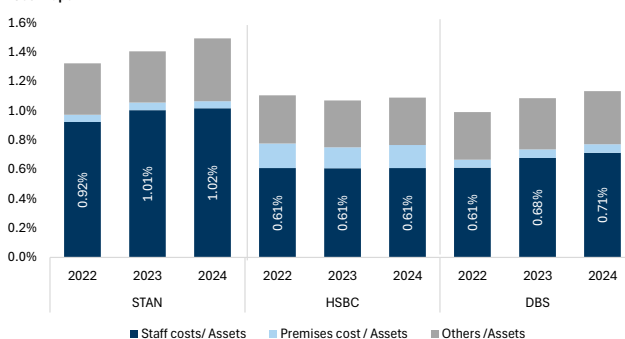


Peer group is HSBC, DBS, OCBC and UOB

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 30: Its staff-related cost-to-assets is the highest...**

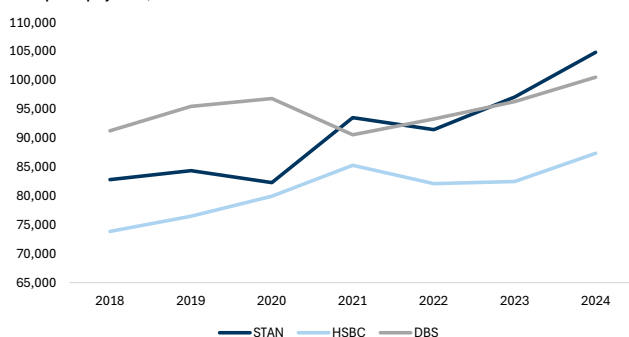
Cost Dupont



Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 31: ... with cost per employee the highest...**

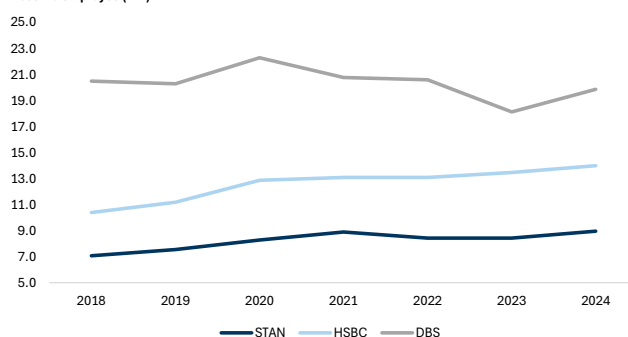
Cost per employee US\$



Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 32: ...and asset-to-employee the lowest vs. peers**

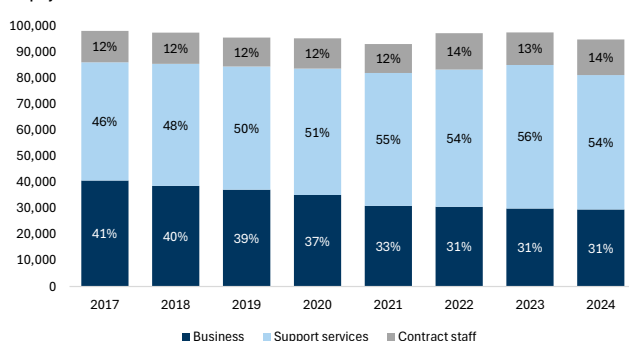
Asset to employee (mn)



Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 33: Faster technology adoption and increased productivity are expected to reduce STAN's reliance on its large support and contract staff**

Employees



Source: Company data, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

**Exhibit 34: Our sensitivity analysis shows a 1ppt improvement in CIR will deliver a 2.9% rise in earnings and a 0.4ppts uplift to ROTE**

2026E Sensitivity analysis

|                    | 0.2ppt | 0.5ppt | 1ppt | 3ppt | 5ppt  |
|--------------------|--------|--------|------|------|-------|
| CIR improvement    |        |        |      |      |       |
| Uplift to Earnings | 0.6%   | 1.4%   | 2.9% | 8.6% | 14.3% |
| Uplift to ROTE     | 0.1%   | 0.2%   | 0.4% | 1.1% | 1.8%  |

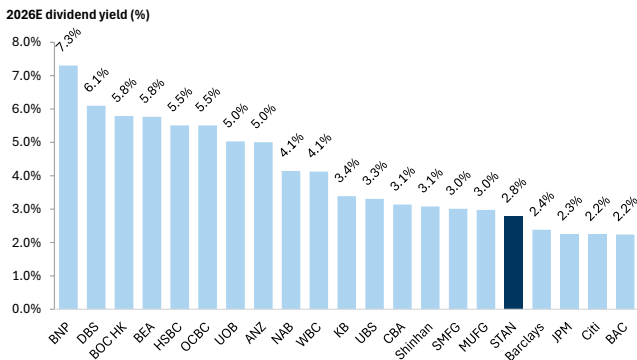
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

#4. Robust and sustainable capital returns to support downside

At current share prices, STAN offers an attractive total shareholder return yield of 8.4% in 2026E, including a 2.8% of dividend yield and a 5.6% yield on share buyback, ranking in the top quartile among major DM banks. We are confident that STAN can maintain its current level of shareholder returns on the back of its strong and improving profitability and moderate RWA growth trajectory, as it focuses on RWA-light growth areas such as Wealth Management (WM) and Global Markets (GM) as highlighted above. Our capital generation model suggests that in the long term, STAN can sustain a total payout ratio of 80% while keeping its CET1 ratio comfortably above the bank’s target range of 13%-14%. Over the last three years, the average total payout has been 80%.

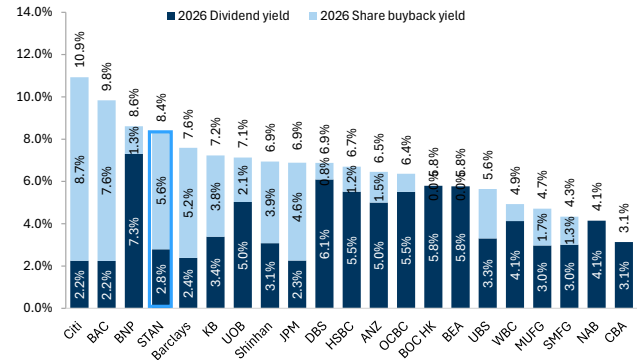
Reflecting this, we raise our 2028E and 2029E share buyback forecasts to \$2.8bn per year (~43%/40% of underlying profit), flat from our 2026-2027E forecasts, and up from \$2.5bn previously. In addition, the bank is committed to increasing DPS over time. With STAN now trading above book value, we believe that it may look to increase the dividend portion of its payout over time, aligning closer to its DM peers trading above book. Accordingly, we raise our 2026-2029E DPO to 25%/30%/35%/40% from a flat 21% previously, which raises DPS by 25%/51%/76%/100%. Our total payout averages 75% for 2026E-2028E vs. an average of 64% prior. Under our revised shareholder return forecasts, STAN’s CET1 is expected to remain broadly stable through 2025-2029E, reaching 14.1% by 2029E, above its target range.

Exhibit 35: STAN offers a 2.8% dividend yield...



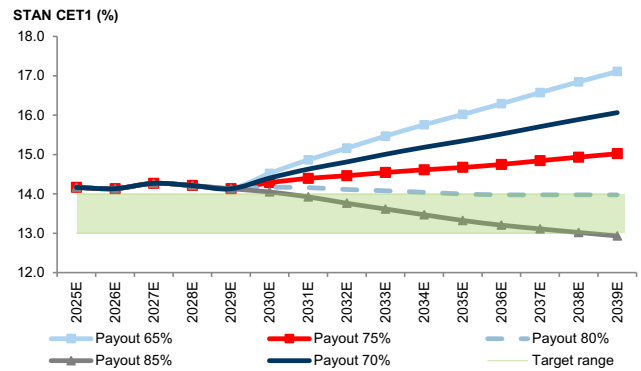
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 36: ...and an 8.4% total shareholder return yield, which we see as decent compared with DM peers



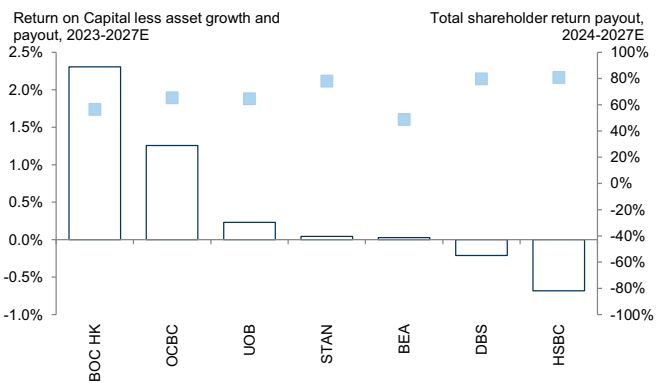
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 37: Our analysis suggests STAN can sustain a total payout ratio of 80%



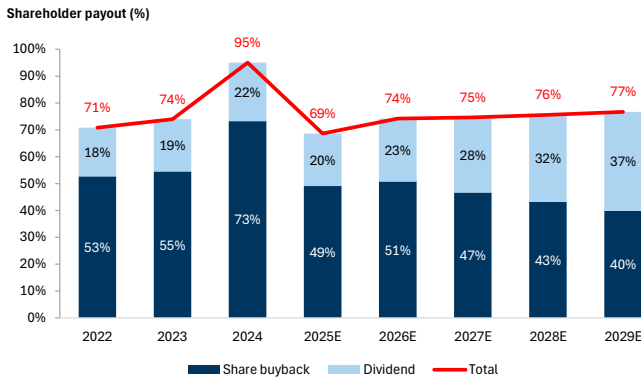
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 38: We expect STAN to remain capital-generative, after taking into consideration loan growth outlook and our forecast of dividend payout and share buybacks



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 39: We forecast an average 7% total shareholder payout ratio for 2026-2029E



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

## Earnings revisions and valuation

We revise our underlying EPS estimates upward by 1%/5%/6% for 2025E/26E/27E, driven by higher NII and non-NII on the back of the robust liquidity momentum.

- **12-month target price of HK\$203 for 2888.HK:** We raise our 12-month target price for 2888.HK to HK\$203 from HK\$168 due to our earnings revisions and updated valuation methodology, where the key changes in our valuation assumptions are:
  - a. a change in valuation methodology to a 2-stage DDM from a RIM-based one to be in line with the methodology we employ across our Asia banks coverage ([Exhibit 42](#)).
  - b. higher long-term payout of 70% from 23%, as we believe STAN is capable of sustaining higher payout in the long term (more discussion in the previous capital returns section).
- **12-month target price of 1,965p for STAN.L:** We raise our 12-month target price for STAN.L to 1,965p from 1,670p as a result of our estimate changes and higher target P/E multiple at 9.5x from 8.5x, given continued successful execution of management's strategic agenda, and a resilient profitability outlook. We value STAN.L using a P/E methodology by applying a 25%/75% blend of our 2026/27E EPS.

### Key downside risks

- **Reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery:** STAN focuses on jaws delivery, with management guiding for positive income-to-cost jaws through 2026 and \$1.5bn in cost savings via the FFG program. If STAN misses or pauses positive jaws delivery, downside risks to our estimates will materialize.
- **Slower-than-expected non-interest income growth:** ~50% of STAN's top line is derived from non-interest income, which has been a strong driver of STAN's growth in the recent years. The Global Markets and Banking business (30% of top line) is sensitive to FX market volatility. If FX volatility remains low, Global Markets activities could remain subdued. Additionally, with a strong presence in Hong Kong and Singapore, tighter mainland China capital controls or increased competition from international peers could potentially slow the growth of STAN's WM income.
- **Lower-than-expected net interest income growth.** If the Fed cuts more than our expectations, or if the HIBOR gap to Fed rate widens, our NII assumptions would face downside risks.

**Exhibit 40: Earnings estimate changes for STAN**

| GS prior vs revised                  | 2025E           |                 | 2026E           |                 | 2027E           |                 | 2028E           |                 | Change, %  |            |            |            |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
| Summary P&L                          | Prior           | Revised         | Prior           | Revised         | Prior           | Revised         | Prior           | Revised         | 2025E      | 2026E      | 2027E      | 2028E      |
| <b>Underlying Operating Income</b>   | <b>20,899</b>   | <b>21,001</b>   | <b>21,363</b>   | <b>21,761</b>   | <b>22,555</b>   | <b>23,122</b>   | <b>23,861</b>   | <b>24,482</b>   | <b>0.5</b> | <b>1.9</b> | <b>2.5</b> | <b>2.6</b> |
| Corporate & Investment Banking       | 12,327          | 12,327          | 12,721          | 12,721          | 13,539          | 13,539          | 14,433          | 14,433          | 0.0        | 0.0        | 0.0        | 0.0        |
| Wealth and Retail Banking            | 8,553           | 8,654           | 8,806           | 9,204           | 9,090           | 9,657           | 9,409           | 10,030          | 1.2        | 4.5        | 6.2        | 6.6        |
| Wealth solutions                     | 3,106           | 3,106           | 3,326           | 3,549           | 3,487           | 3,833           | 3,653           | 4,025           | 0.0        | 6.7        | 9.9        | 10.2       |
| Deposits & mortgages & others        | 5,447           | 5,548           | 5,480           | 5,655           | 5,603           | 5,823           | 5,756           | 6,005           | 1.9        | 3.2        | 3.9        | 4.3        |
| Ventures                             | 403             | 403             | 210             | 210             | 263             | 263             | 322             | 322             | 0.0        | 0.0        | 0.0        | 0.0        |
| Central & other items                | (374)           | (374)           | (374)           | (374)           | (337)           | (337)           | (303)           | (303)           | 0.0        | 0.0        | 0.0        | 0.0        |
| <b>Underlying Operating Expenses</b> | <b>(12,315)</b> | <b>(12,315)</b> | <b>(12,426)</b> | <b>(12,476)</b> | <b>(12,805)</b> | <b>(12,917)</b> | <b>(13,277)</b> | <b>(13,442)</b> | <b>0.0</b> | <b>0.4</b> | <b>0.9</b> | <b>1.2</b> |
| <b>Underlying PPOP</b>               | <b>8,584</b>    | <b>8,685</b>    | <b>8,937</b>    | <b>9,285</b>    | <b>9,750</b>    | <b>10,205</b>   | <b>10,583</b>   | <b>11,041</b>   | <b>1.2</b> | <b>3.9</b> | <b>4.7</b> | <b>4.3</b> |
| Loan provisions                      | (737)           | (737)           | (851)           | (851)           | (962)           | (962)           | (1,107)         | (1,107)         | 0          | 0          | 0          | 0          |
| Other provisions                     | (65)            | (65)            | (144)           | (144)           | (144)           | (144)           | (144)           | (144)           | 0          | 0          | 0          | 0          |
| Income from associates               | 70              | 70              | 46              | 46              | 47              | 47              | 48              | 48              | 0          | 0          | 0          | 0          |
| <b>Underlying PBT</b>                | <b>7,852</b>    | <b>7,953</b>    | <b>7,988</b>    | <b>8,336</b>    | <b>8,691</b>    | <b>9,146</b>    | <b>9,381</b>    | <b>9,838</b>    | <b>1</b>   | <b>4</b>   | <b>5</b>   | <b>5</b>   |
| <b>Underlying NPAT</b>               | <b>5,437</b>    | <b>5,504</b>    | <b>5,265</b>    | <b>5,512</b>    | <b>5,676</b>    | <b>5,999</b>    | <b>6,165</b>    | <b>6,490</b>    | <b>1</b>   | <b>5</b>   | <b>6</b>   | <b>5</b>   |
| <b>Underlying EPS (US\$)</b>         | <b>2.27</b>     | <b>2.30</b>     | <b>2.34</b>     | <b>2.45</b>     | <b>2.70</b>     | <b>2.85</b>     | <b>3.13</b>     | <b>3.31</b>     | <b>1</b>   | <b>5</b>   | <b>6</b>   | <b>6</b>   |
| Stated EPS (US\$)                    | 2.00            | 2.03            | 2.12            | 2.23            | 2.77            | 2.93            | 3.23            | 3.41            | 1          | 5          | 6          | 6          |
| <b>DPS (US\$)</b>                    | <b>0.47</b>     | <b>0.48</b>     | <b>0.49</b>     | <b>0.61</b>     | <b>0.57</b>     | <b>0.85</b>     | <b>0.66</b>     | <b>1.16</b>     | <b>1</b>   | <b>25</b>  | <b>51</b>  | <b>76</b>  |
| Share buyback                        | 2,800           | 2,800           | 2,800           | 2,800           | 2,800           | 2,800           | 2,500           | 2,800           | 0          | 0          | 0          | 12         |
| Total assets                         | 911,444         | 913,963         | 935,521         | 954,883         | 956,374         | 986,036         | 981,796         | 1,015,178       | 0          | 2          | 3          | 3          |
| Gross loans                          | 45,612          | 45,612          | 45,612          | 45,612          | 45,612          | 45,612          | 45,612          | 45,612          | 0          | 0          | 0          | 0          |
| Customer accounts                    | 524,308         | 526,773         | 547,619         | 566,936         | 566,759         | 596,623         | 589,775         | 624,241         | 0          | 4          | 5          | 6          |
| BVPS (US\$)                          | 19.8            | 19.8            | 21.5            | 21.5            | 24.0            | 23.9            | 26.9            | 26.6            | 0          | 0          | (0)        | (1)        |

Based on underlying operating income/EPS.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 41: Financial summary

|                                       |          |          |          |          |          |          | YoY   |        |         |         |         |
|---------------------------------------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|-------|--------|---------|---------|---------|
|                                       | 2023     | 2024     | 2025E    | 2026E    | 2027E    | 2028E    | 24/23 | 25E/24 | 26E/25E | 27E/26E | 28E/27E |
| Underlying P&L (\$mn)                 |          |          |          |          |          |          |       |        |         |         |         |
| Revenue                               | 17,378   | 19,696   | 21,001   | 21,761   | 23,122   | 24,482   | 13%   | 7%     | 4%      | 6%      | 6%      |
| Corporate & Investment Banking        | 11,312   | 11,935   | 12,327   | 12,721   | 13,539   | 14,433   | 6%    | 3%     | 3%      | 6%      | 7%      |
| Wealth and Retail Banking             | 7,219    | 8,021    | 8,654    | 9,204    | 9,657    | 10,030   | 11%   | 8%     | 6%      | 5%      | 4%      |
| Wealth solutions                      | 1,944    | 2,490    | 3,106    | 3,549    | 3,833    | 4,025    | 28%   | 25%    | 14%     | 8%      | 5%      |
| Deposits & mortgages & others         | 5,275    | 5,531    | 5,548    | 5,655    | 5,823    | 6,005    | 5%    | 0%     | 2%      | 3%      | 3%      |
| Ventures                              | 156      | 183      | 403      | 210      | 263      | 322      | 17%   | 120%   | (48%)   | 25%     | 22%     |
| Central & other items                 | (1,309)  | (738)    | (374)    | (374)    | (337)    | (303)    | (44%) | (49%)  | 0%      | (10%)   | (10%)   |
| Costs                                 | (11,136) | (11,790) | (12,315) | (12,476) | (12,917) | (13,442) | 6%    | 4%     | 1%      | 4%      | 4%      |
| Pre-Provision Profit                  | 6,242    | 7,906    | 8,685    | 9,285    | 10,205   | 11,041   | 27%   | 10%    | 7%      | 10%     | 8%      |
| Impairments                           | (658)    | (1,145)  | (802)    | (995)    | (1,106)  | (1,251)  | 74%   | (30%)  | 24%     | 11%     | 13%     |
| Operating profit                      | 5,584    | 6,761    | 7,883    | 8,290    | 9,099    | 9,790    | 21%   | 17%    | 5%      | 10%     | 8%      |
| Associates                            | 94       | 50       | 70       | 46       | 47       | 48       | (47%) | 40%    | (33%)   | 2%      | 2%      |
| PBT - Underlying                      | 5,678    | 6,811    | 7,953    | 8,336    | 9,146    | 9,838    | 20%   | 17%    | 5%      | 10%     | 8%      |
| Statutory P&L (\$mn)                  |          |          |          |          |          |          |       |        |         |         |         |
| PBT - Statutory                       | 5,093    | 6,309    | 7,127    | 7,599    | 9,146    | 9,838    | 24%   | 13%    | 7%      | 20%     | 8%      |
| Profit After Tax - Statutory          | 3,462    | 4,042    | 5,276    | 5,395    | 6,494    | 6,985    | 17%   | 31%    | 2%      | 20%     | 8%      |
| Non-Controlling interests             | 7        | 8        | (13)     | 8        | 8        | 8        | 14%   | (263%) | (162%)  | -       | -       |
| Other                                 | (452)    | (457)    | (545)    | (545)    | (545)    | (545)    | 1%    | 19%    | -       | -       | -       |
| Net Income to Ordinary Shareholders   | 3,017    | 3,593    | 4,718    | 4,858    | 5,957    | 6,448    | 19%   | 31%    | 3%      | 23%     | 8%      |
| Balance Sheet                         |          |          |          |          |          |          |       |        |         |         |         |
| Loans and advances to customers (net) | \$287bn  | \$281bn  | \$289bn  | \$299bn  | \$309bn  | \$324bn  | (2%)  | 3%     | 3%      | 3%      | 5%      |
| Customer accounts                     | \$469bn  | \$464bn  | \$527bn  | \$567bn  | \$597bn  | \$624bn  | (1%)  | 13%    | 8%      | 5%      | 5%      |
| RWAs                                  | \$244bn  | \$247bn  | \$261bn  | \$267bn  | \$275bn  | \$286bn  | 1%    | 6%     | 2%      | 3%      | 4%      |
| Key Ratios & Metrics                  |          |          |          |          |          |          |       |        |         |         |         |
| CET1 ratio                            | 14.1%    | 14.2%    | 14.2%    | 14.1%    | 14.3%    | 14.2%    | 19bp  | (8bp)  | (3bp)   | 14bp    | (6bp)   |
| Credit cost                           | 0.18%    | 0.20%    | 0.26%    | 0.29%    | 0.32%    | 0.35%    | 2bp   | 6bp    | 3bp     | 3bp     | 3bp     |
| ROTE                                  | 8.3%     | 9.7%     | 12.5%    | 12.5%    | 14.9%    | 15.6%    | 141bp | 276bp  | 2bp     | 240bp   | 65bp    |
| EPS (\$)                              | 1.1      | 1.4      | 2.0      | 2.2      | 2.9      | 3.4      | 31%   | 42%    | 10%     | 31%     | 16%     |
| DPS (\$)                              | 0.3      | 0.4      | 0.5      | 0.6      | 0.9      | 1.2      | 37%   | 30%    | 28%     | 39%     | 35%     |
| TBVPs (\$)                            | 13.9     | 15.4     | 17.1     | 18.6     | 20.7     | 23.2     | 11%   | 11%    | 9%      | 11%     | 12%     |

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 42: 2-stage DDM model

| Company name | Ticker  | Upside/<br>downside to<br>12m TP | Rating | 12-m Target<br>Price (Local<br>Currency) | Current Price<br>(Local<br>Currency) as<br>of 0 | Capital Asset Pricing Model |                        |      |                   | Dividend Discount Model Assumptions |            |                  |        | Implied Target |       |
|--------------|---------|----------------------------------|--------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------|------|-------------------|-------------------------------------|------------|------------------|--------|----------------|-------|
|              |         |                                  |        |                                          |                                                 | Risk Free                   | Market Risk<br>Premium | Beta | Cost of<br>Equity | Stage 1                             |            | Terminal Stage 2 |        | P/B            | P/E   |
|              |         |                                  |        |                                          |                                                 |                             |                        |      |                   | Div CAGR                            | No. of Yrs | ROE              | Growth |                |       |
| STAN         | 2888.HK | 16%                              | Buy    | 203.0                                    | 174.4                                           | 3.0%                        | 6.0%                   | 1.20 | 10.2%             | 5.6%                                | 3          | 13.0%            | 2.6%   | 1.40X          | 10.8X |

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 43: Valuation comp

|                               | GS<br>Rating | Last<br>Price | 12m Target<br>Price | Target<br>Price<br>Return | Total<br>Return | P/B (X) |       |       | P/E (X) |       |       | ROA (%) |       |       | ROE (%) |       |       | EPS growth (%) |       |       | Div Yield (%) |       |       |
|-------------------------------|--------------|---------------|---------------------|---------------------------|-----------------|---------|-------|-------|---------|-------|-------|---------|-------|-------|---------|-------|-------|----------------|-------|-------|---------------|-------|-------|
|                               |              |               |                     |                           |                 | 2025E   | 2026E | 2027E | 2025E   | 2026E | 2027E | 2025E   | 2026E | 2027E | 2025E   | 2026E | 2027E | 2025E          | 2026E | 2027E | 2025E         | 2026E | 2027E |
| DBS Group                     | Buy          | S\$ 54.12     | S\$ 64.50           | 19%                       | 25%             | 2.2     | 2.2   | 2.1   | 13.8    | 13.0  | 12.2  | 1.30    | 1.28  | 1.30  | 16.5    | 16.9  | 17.6  | -1.9           | 5.7   | 7.0   | 5.7           | 6.1   | 6.5   |
| United Overseas Bank          | Neutral      | S\$ 34.28     | S\$ 38.00           | 11%                       | 15%             | 1.2     | 1.1   | 1.1   | 12.7    | 10.4  | 9.7   | 0.82    | 0.96  | 0.98  | 9.5     | 11.3  | 11.5  | -23.1          | 22.4  | 6.9   | 4.4           | 5.0   | 5.4   |
| Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. | Buy          | S\$ 18.79     | S\$ 21.20           | 13%                       | 18%             | 1.4     | 1.4   | 1.3   | 11.5    | 11.6  | 10.8  | 1.15    | 1.08  | 1.11  | 12.6    | 12.0  | 12.4  | -2.4           | -0.9  | 7.3   | 5.5           | 5.5   | 5.6   |
| Singapore (Average)           |              |               |                     |                           |                 | 1.6     | 1.6   | 1.5   | 12.6    | 11.6  | 10.9  | 1.09    | 1.10  | 1.13  | 12.9    | 13.4  | 13.8  | -9.1           | 9.1   | 7.1   | 5.2           | 5.5   | 5.8   |
| HSBC Holdings                 | Not Rated    | HK\$ 109.5    | NA                  | NA                        | NA              | 1.5     | 1.4   | 1.3   | 9.7     | 9.0   | 8.3   | 0.65    | 0.80  | 0.84  | 16.8    | 16.4  | 16.3  | 8.0            | 7.0   | 8.5   | 5.2           | 5.5   | 6.0   |
| Standard Chartered Bank       | Buy          | HK\$ 170.6    | HK\$ 203.0          | 19%                       | 21%             | 1.3     | 1.2   | 1.1   | 9.5     | 8.9   | 7.7   | 0.54    | 0.52  | 0.61  | 14.6    | 14.2  | 15.0  | 44.9           | 6.9   | 16.2  | 2.2           | 2.8   | 3.9   |
| BOC Hong Kong (Holdings)      | Neutral      | HK\$ 37.38    | HK\$ 41.2           | 10%                       | 16%             | 1.1     | 1.1   | 1.0   | 10.4    | 9.8   | 8.7   | 0.86    | 0.84  | 0.89  | 10.9    | 11.0  | 11.7  | -0.8           | 5.9   | 13.1  | 5.4           | 5.8   | 6.7   |
| Bank of East Asia             | Sell         | HK\$ 13.03    | HK\$ 12.9           | -1%                       | 4%              | 0.3     | 0.3   | 0.3   | 9.3     | 8.7   | 6.8   | 0.42    | 0.43  | 0.53  | 3.6     | 3.7   | 4.6   | -7.5           | 6.9   | 27.3  | 5.3           | 5.8   | 7.5   |
| Hong Kong (Average)           |              |               |                     |                           |                 | 1.1     | 1.0   | 0.9   | 9.7     | 9.1   | 7.9   | 0.62    | 0.65  | 0.72  | 11.5    | 11.3  | 11.9  | 11.2           | 6.7   | 16.3  | 4.5           | 5.0   | 6.0   |

P/TB and ROTE for STAN and HSBC, pricing as of Dec 9th, 2025

Source: FactSet, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

| STAN.L                         |                      | 12m Price Target: 1965p |         | Price: 1669p |         | Upside: 17.7% |  |
|--------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------|---------|--------------|---------|---------------|--|
| Buy                            |                      | GS Forecast             |         |              |         |               |  |
|                                |                      |                         | 12/24   | 12/25E       | 12/26E  | 12/27E        |  |
| Market cap: £38.3bn / \$50.9bn | Net inc. (\$ mn) New | 3,593.0                 | 4,718.3 | 4,858.4      | 5,956.7 |               |  |
| 3m ADTV :£74.4mn/ \$99.0mn     | Net inc. (\$ mn) Old | 3,593.0                 | 4,651.5 | 4,611.5      | 5,633.5 |               |  |
| United Kingdom                 | EPS (\$ New)         | 1.58                    | 2.30    | 2.45         | 2.85    |               |  |
| Europe Banks                   | EPS (\$ Old)         | 1.58                    | 2.27    | 2.34         | 2.70    |               |  |
|                                | EPS growth (%)       | 22.7                    | 44.9    | 6.9          | 16.2    |               |  |
| M&A Rank: 3                    | P/E (X)              | 6.1                     | 9.7     | 9.1          | 7.8     |               |  |
|                                | P/B (X)              | 0.5                     | 1.1     | 1.0          | 0.9     |               |  |
|                                | Price/PPOP (X)       | 7.2                     | 6.5     | 6.0          | 5.0     |               |  |
|                                | Dividend yield (%)   | 3.8                     | 2.2     | 2.8          | 3.8     |               |  |
|                                |                      | 9/25                    | 12/25E  | 3/26E        | 6/26E   |               |  |
|                                | EPS (\$)             | 0.53                    | 0.38    | 0.63         | 0.72    |               |  |

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 09 Dec 2025 close.

| 2888.HK                            |  | 12m Price Target: HK\$203 | Price: HK\$170.6 | Upside: 19% |         |         |
|------------------------------------|--|---------------------------|------------------|-------------|---------|---------|
| Buy                                |  | GS Forecast               |                  |             |         |         |
|                                    |  |                           | 12/24            | 12/25E      | 12/26E  | 12/27E  |
| Market cap: HK\$391.2bn / \$50.3bn |  | Net inc. (\$ mn) New      | 3,593.0          | 4,718.3     | 4,858.4 | 5,956.7 |
| 3m ADTV :HK\$125.2mn/ \$16.1mn     |  | Net inc. (\$ mn) Old      | 3,593.0          | 4,651.5     | 4,611.5 | 5,633.5 |
| Hong Kong                          |  | EPS (HK\$) New            | 12.32            | 17.86       | 19.09   | 22.19   |
| Hong Kong Financials               |  | EPS (HK\$) Old            | 12.32            | 17.64       | 18.24   | 20.99   |
|                                    |  | EPS growth (%)            | 23.1             | 45.1        | 7.1     | 16.2    |
| M&A Rank: 3                        |  | P/E (X)                   | 6.1              | 9.6         | 8.9     | 7.7     |
|                                    |  | P/B (X)                   | 0.5              | 1.1         | 1.0     | 0.9     |
|                                    |  | Price/PPOP (X)            | 7.1              | 6.4         | 5.9     | 4.9     |
|                                    |  | Dividend yield (%)        | 3.8              | 2.2         | 2.8     | 3.9     |
|                                    |  |                           | 6/25             | 9/25        | 12/25E  | --      |
|                                    |  | EPS (HK\$)                | 5.88             | 4.11        | 2.94    | --      |

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 09 Dec 2025 close.

**Price Target Risks and Methodology — Standard Chartered (STAN.L)**

We are Buy-rated on STAN.L with a 12-month P/E-based target price of 1,965p, based on an 9.5x target P/E multiple. Downside risks include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, slower-than-expected non-interest income growth, lower-than-expected net interest income growth.

**Price Target Risks and Methodology — Standard Chartered Bank (2888.HK)**

We are Buy-rated on STAN (2888.HK) with a 12-month 2-stage DDM-based target price of HK\$203. Downside risks include reversal/pause of positive jaws delivery, slower-than-expected non-interest income growth, lower-than-expected net interest income growth.

**Investment thesis — Standard Chartered (STAN.L/2888.HK)**

Standard Chartered is a global bank with over 650 branches in 53 markets. STAN HK is the 3rd largest player, holding ~12%/11% of HK local market shares in deposits/loans. We are Buy rated on STAN.L/2888.HK given **(1) Robust and sustained momentum in the affluent segment.** We see the bank as well-positioned to leverage the robust and sustained liquidity inflows into Hong Kong and Singapore, a significant tailwind that we believe will continue to fuel its growth and differentiate its performance from peers. **(2) Positive trajectory in Global Markets and Banking,** underpinned by steady market share gains. **(3) Positive jaws with scope to further unlock operational leverage.** **(4) Attractive shareholder returns** with total yield (dividend + buybacks) ranking among the top quartile of DM comps. We forecast underlying ROTEs to reach 14.6% by the end of 2025E (exceeding management's guidance of 13% ROTE) and to further improve in 2027-2028E. As such, we anticipate STAN will upgrade its ROTE guidance for the medium term at its FY2025 results or its upcoming Investor Day in May 2026, which should serve as a further catalyst for the shares. We expect STAN to consistently deliver solid quarterly earnings that will help enhance investor confidence, which should lead to a re-rating of the shares back to its 2011-2014 median valuation of 1.4X P/B, when it had a similar profitability profile.

## Disclosure Appendix

### Reg AC

We, Melissa Kuang, CFA, Chris Hallam, Benjamin Caven-Roberts, Olivia Shi and Wuzmal Handu, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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**Growth** is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

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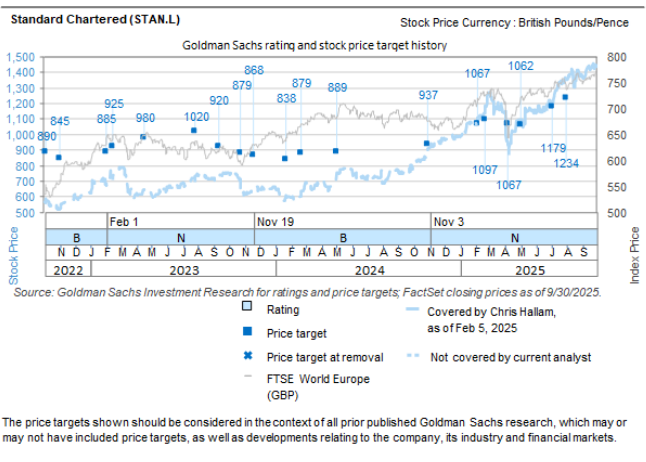
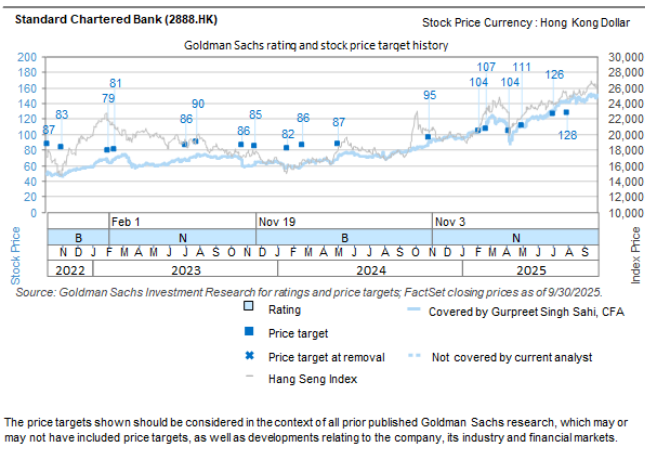
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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